LITTLE WONDERS ESL

Geography Word Lab: Reading maps

Level A2 · about 25 minutes · symbols, scale and directions



1 BRAIN TEASERS

Read the clue. Write the English word in the boxes.

1. I am a small picture on a map. I can show a school, a river or a road.
2. I show how a distance on the map matches a distance in real life.
3. I am a tool with a needle that points north. On a map, my picture is called a rose.

2 COOL FACT: HOW TO READ A MAP

A **map** is a drawing of a place as you see it from above. The **key** explains the **symbols** on the map. For example, a blue line can be a river. The **scale** shows how a distance on the map matches a distance in real life. For example, one centimetre can be one kilometre. A **compass rose** shows the four main directions: north, south, east and west. The **equator** is a line at zero degrees latitude, and it goes around the middle of Earth.

drawing = a picture made with a pencil or a pen

directions = north, south, east and west

distance = how far it is from one place to another

latitude = the lines on a map that go around Earth, like the equator

3 WORD HUNT

Across or down

U	O	C	O	M	P	A	S	S	D	H	A
W	N	E	S	O	U	T	H	Y	A	E	D
E	O	S	C	A	L	E	T	M	R	O	A
S	R	T	N	M	A	P	N	B	L	N	F
T	T	E	E	L	R	C	F	O	E	L	M
T	H	N	S	V	A	A	A	L	A	O	G
G	L	J	E	F	R	E	A	S	T	H	E
N	O	A	Y	T	H	R	T	N	A	E	N

WORD BANK

- ☐ **symbol**
- ☐ **scale**
- ☐ **compass**
- ☐ **north**
- ☐ **south**
- ☐ **east**
- ☐ **west**
- ☐ **map**

4 SPEAK

Tell your teacher in your own words (about 1 minute)

1. What does the key on a map explain?
2. What is a scale?
3. What are the four main directions?